

Adobe patches

Adobe has fixed 29 vulnerabilities in Adobe Acrobat and Reader

Mobile Photoshop

You can now edit your photos effectively on your mobile handsets with Adobe's Photoshop.com Mobile for iPhone

The art of Acrobatics

Ajay Pande, VP Engineering, Adobe India on Adobe's Indian operations, engineering and design vision

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Tell us about the engineering and product design teams at Adobe India

Adobe India's engineering and product design teams are based out of two locations – Noida and Bangalore. We've been operating out of India and exclusively focussing on several products for the past 12 years. Our current engineering headcount for India is 1500.

What kind of talent do you look for while recruiting?

Sheer brightness and brilliance is something that excites us. For this, we go to the top institutes. For engineering and business talent, we look for people with passion and love for technology. The person should be willing to experiment and have the willingness to learn. We do not prefer people who keep switching between technologies or someone who is on the run. Adobe products are benchmarks – always the best. This translates even to our resources. We get the best whatever be the field. In addition, we have a strong rotation process, whereby engineers can move on to the product line of their choice depending on his/her interest.

Which is the most extensive market for Adobe? If US/Europe, is it still convenient to develop here and market it abroad?

When it comes to our products, approximately half of it is consumed in the Americas and the other half comes in Europe and Japan. We have managed to grow with corresponding growth in the respective industries. We are excited about this and expect to continue this trend in the years to come. Adobe Elements shipped to the world, was developed in India. Overall, Adobe is not geographic specific. If you compare Adobe with other software manufacturers, Adobe is clearly the leader. Our products are not localised to such an extent that their behaviour patterns change. In fact, whenever our client/customer industries have grown, Adobe's stable has grown. For example, in a country such as India, with the growth of the print industry, InDesign has seen rapid growth. Similarly with the future moving towards the cloud, Flash is witnessing growth.

What is significant about Elements?

Adobe Photoshop Elements and Adobe Premiere Elements were recently shipped globally. These product lines were developed entirely in India. Designers, especially for web and print platforms, extensively use Photoshop. Similarly, video editors use Adobe Premiere. Our latest addition, Adobe Elements, is targeted at hobbyists. Although not as critical as designers and editors, hobbyists do want their product to appear as professional as possible. This is where Elements steps in.

Does Adobe do all of its development work, or do you outsource? Tell us more about it from an Indian perspective. Also tell us what goes in the whole cycle.



Considering the criticality of our software applications, we consider this to be *our* business in all respects, and we carry all development work ourselves. Although we do have development partners, we do not outsource any of our development work. Basically, our product development cycle or product lifecycle begins with what is called a seed idea. A seed idea could come from anyone, be it an engineer or a manager or a director. When someone has an idea, they can communicate the idea by means of forums dedicated for this purpose. This is known as the incubation board. While the idea grows there, it is also reviewed. This whole process could take anywhere between 9 months to 18 months. The dedicated team then works on the idea as a start-up within Adobe. When results are visible, the senior management reviews the idea as a business plan. This review by the senior management is called the concept accept. The whole atmosphere is informal for the idea to evolve. However, once it takes the form of a business idea, it is strictly process driven and very formal in nature.

Can you tell our readers more about the Indian names we see during startup of Adobe products?

These names are mostly engineers and some managers. If you look at Acrobat, half of the names in the credit are Indians, not just by nationality, but based out of the India office. There are over a hundred Indian names. Even in Photoshop, you will find several Indian names. One such name is Seetharaman Narayanan, who is one of Adobe's early engineers based out of USA. 